

Converting Figma prototype to coded app ▾

I currently have a figma prototype of a mobile app. I'd like to code this app with claude code, it's important that all margin paddings and sizes are exactly like my prototype and all functions work as intended. What would be the best approach and plan to correctly build the app? Is a pdf including all the screens + a written prompt enough or is there a different approach that would work best for my case?

Great question — getting Claude Code to faithfully reproduce a Figma prototype is very doable, but the approach matters a lot. Here's an honest breakdown:

A PDF + written prompt: good start, but not enough on its own

A PDF of screens gives Claude Code the *visual reference*, but it's missing the precision layer — exact spacing values, component states, interactions, and assets. Claude will estimate what it can't read precisely, which leads to drift from your design.

The Best Approach: Layered Handoff

1. Export a proper design spec from Figma (highest impact)

Use one of these methods:

- **Figma Dev Mode** (built-in) — inspect exact px values, spacing, fonts, colors, and export CSS/iOS/Android snippets per element. Copy these specs into a markdown file for Claude Code.
- **Figma to Code plugin** — auto-generates HTML/CSS or React code as a starting scaffold.
- **Export your design tokens** — colors, typography, spacing as a JSON or CSS variables file. Claude Code will use these as the source of truth.

2. Structure your prompt as a spec document, not a description

Instead of "build a login screen that looks like this," give Claude Code:

```
Screen: Login
- Container padding: 24px horizontal, 48px top
- Logo: 120x120px, centered, 64px from top
- Input height: 52px, border-radius: 12px, border: 1px #E0E0E0
```

- Button: full-width, height 56px, border-radius: 14px, bg: #3B82F6
- Font: Inter 16px/400 for inputs, 16px/600 for button label

This is what Claude Code can work with precisely.

3. Export assets directly from Figma

- Export icons as **SVG** (not PNG)
- Export images at **2x/3x** for retina
- Name them semantically (`icon-home.svg`, `avatar-placeholder.png`)
- Put them in a folder and reference them explicitly in your prompt

4. Include interaction/flow notes

For each screen, note:

- What tapping each element does
- Any animations or transitions (e.g., "slide in from right")
- Loading/empty/error states

Recommended Workflow

```
Figma → Dev Mode spec export (markdown/JSON)
      → Asset export (SVG + images)
      → Screen PDF (visual reference)
      → Flow/interaction notes
      ↓
      Claude Code project
```

Feed Claude Code the **spec first**, then use the PDF as a visual sanity check. Build screen by screen — don't dump everything at once.

Pro tip: Use a component-first approach

Tell Claude Code to build your **design system first** (buttons, inputs, cards, colors, typography) before building screens. This way every screen is assembled from consistent, reusable pieces — much closer to how Figma components work.

Bottom line: PDF alone will get you ~60-70% fidelity. PDF + Figma Dev Mode specs + exported assets + interaction notes will get you to 90%+. The spec precision is the key differentiator.

Want help structuring your Claude Code prompt template or the spec document format?

I'd like the app to be programmed with html/css and javascript. Could you give me a detailed guide on how to export the design out of figma to be used for devlopment with claude?

Check for frontend design skill >

Here's a comprehensive guide for exporting from Figma specifically for HTML/CSS/JS development:

Complete Figma → HTML/CSS/JS Export Guide

Step 1: Set Up Dev Mode in Figma

Dev Mode is your most important tool — it shows exact values instead of estimates.

1. Open your Figma file
2. Click the </> icon in the top toolbar (or press **Shift + D**)
3. You're now in Dev Mode — clicking any element shows its exact specs

Step 2: Export Your Design Tokens

Design tokens are your colors, fonts, and spacing — the foundation of your CSS.

Colors:

1. In Dev Mode, click on any colored element
2. In the right panel, find **Fill** → copy the hex value
3. Do this for every unique color in your design
4. Organize them like this for Claude:

```
CSS
```

```
/* Paste this into your prompt for Claude */
:root {
  --color-primary: #3B82F6;
  --color-background: #F9FAFB;
```

```
--color-text: #111827;  
--color-text-muted: #6B7280;  
--color-border: #E5E7EB;  
--color-error: #EF4444;  
}
```

Typography:

1. Click any text element in Dev Mode
2. The right panel shows: font family, weight, size, line height, letter spacing
3. Export like this:

CSS

```
:root {  
  --font-family: 'Inter', sans-serif;  
  --text-xs: 12px;  
  --text-sm: 14px;  
  --text-base: 16px;  
  --text-lg: 18px;  
  --text-xl: 24px;  
  --text-2xl: 32px;  
  --font-regular: 400;  
  --font-medium: 500;  
  --font-semibold: 600;  
  --font-bold: 700;  
  --line-height-tight: 1.2;  
  --line-height-normal: 1.5;  
}
```

Spacing: Note your base spacing unit (usually 4px or 8px) and all padding/margin values used across screens.

Step 3: Export Specs Per Screen (The Most Important Step)

For **each screen**, do the following in Dev Mode:

1. Click the screen/frame → note its dimensions (e.g. **390 × 844px** for iPhone 14)
2. Click each element and note its values from the right panel

Create a spec file like this for each screen:

```
=== SCREEN: Home Feed ===  
Frame: 390 × 844px, bg: #F9FAFB
```

[Header]

- Height: 56px
- Padding: 0 24px
- Background: #FFFFFF
- Border-bottom: 1px solid #E5E7EB

[Logo]

- Width: 80px, Height: 24px
- Position: left, vertically centered

[Notification Icon]

- Size: 24 × 24px
- Position: right, vertically centered
- Badge: 8px circle, bg: #EF4444, top-right of icon

[Post Card]

- Margin: 16px 24px
- Padding: 16px
- Border-radius: 16px
- Background: #FFFFFF
- Box-shadow: 0 1px 3px rgba(0,0,0,0.08)

[User Avatar]

- Size: 40 × 40px
- Border-radius: 50%
- Margin-right: 12px

[Username]

- Font: Inter 14px/600, color: #111827

[Timestamp]

- Font: Inter 12px/400, color: #6B7280
- Margin-top: 2px

Tip: Use Figma's **Copy as CSS** button in Dev Mode for quick value extraction — click an element, then look for the copy icon next to CSS properties.

Step 4: Export Assets

Icons:

1. Select the icon frame/component
2. Right panel → **Export** section → click +
3. Set format to **SVG**, suffix blank

4. Click **Export** [name]
5. Repeat for every icon, naming them semantically: `icon-home.svg`, `icon-search.svg`

Images/Illustrations:

1. Select the image element
2. Export → format **PNG**, scale **2x** (for retina sharpness)
3. Name: `img-hero.png`, `avatar-placeholder.png`

App Icon / Logo:

1. Export as **SVG** if vector, **PNG @2x** if raster

Organize your exports:

```
/assets
  /icons
    icon-home.svg
    icon-search.svg
    icon-profile.svg
  /images
    img-onboarding-1.png
    avatar-placeholder.png
```

Step 5: Document Interactions & States

Figma shows you the visuals but not the behavior — write this down manually for each interactive element:

```
=== INTERACTIONS ===
```

```
[Bottom Navigation]
```

- 4 tabs: Home, Search, Add, Profile
- Active tab: icon color changes to #3B82F6, label visible
- Inactive tab: icon color #9CA3AF, no label
- Tap → navigate to corresponding screen (no animation)

```
[Post Card → Tap]
```

- Navigate to Post Detail screen
- Transition: slide in from right, 300ms ease

```
[Like Button]
```

- Empty + blur: red border, error text "Email is required" below
- Invalid format: "Enter a valid email address"
- Valid: green checkmark icon appears inside input right side

→ Settings (tap gear icon)

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```
## Files to create
index.html, style.css, app.js, /screens/, /components/

## Design Tokens
[paste your CSS variables here]

## Assets
All icons are SVGs in /assets/icons/
All images are in /assets/images/

## Screen 1: [Name]
[paste your spec]

## Interactions for Screen 1:
[paste interaction notes]
```

Then tell Claude: "**Build one screen at a time, starting with the design system (CSS variables + base components), then Screen 1.**"

Quick Checklist Before Starting Development

- ☐ Dev Mode enabled, all px values noted per screen
- ☐ All colors exported as CSS variables
- ☐ All font families, sizes, weights documented
- ☐ All icons exported as SVG
- ☐ All images exported as PNG @2x
- ☐ Interaction/state notes written for every interactive element
- ☐ Navigation flow documented
- ☐ Figma screen PDF exported as visual reference backup

The PDF is then just a **sanity check** — the spec files are what Claude actually builds from.

what is the fastest way to export multiple screens

The fastest method by far is the **Figma plugin "Exportify"** or using **bulk export** built into Figma. Here's the quickest path:

Fastest Way: Built-in Bulk Export

1. Select All Frames at Once

- In the left panel (Layers), click your first screen frame
- **Shift + Click** the last one to select all screens
- Or **Ctrl/Cmd + A** if your page only contains screens

2. Add Export Setting to All at Once

- With all frames selected, go to the right panel → scroll to **Export** section
- Click + → set format to **PDF**
- This applies the export setting to **all selected frames simultaneously**

3. Export

- Click **Export [X] layers**
- Figma exports all screens as a **single multi-page PDF** — one screen per page

That's it. ~30 seconds for all screens.

For Assets (Icons/Images) — Use "Export All" Plugin

The fastest plugin for this is "**Batch Export**" (free, Figma Community):

1. Install it from the Figma Community (**Menu → Plugins → Manage plugins → search "Batch Export"**)
 2. Select all your icon/image frames
 3. Run the plugin → choose SVG for icons, PNG @2x for images
 4. Downloads everything as a ZIP in one click
-

For Dev Specs — Use the "Inspect" Copy Trick

Instead of clicking element by element:

1. Switch to **Dev Mode**
 2. Select a whole screen frame
 3. Right panel shows the frame's CSS — click **Copy All** to grab everything at once
 4. For individual elements, click them and use **Copy as CSS** — it copies all properties (size, color, font, spacing) in one shot
-

Recommended 3-Step Bulk Export Flow

What	Method	Time
All screens as PDF	Select all → Export as PDF	30 sec
All icons	Batch Export plugin → SVG	1 min
All images	Batch Export plugin → PNG @2x	1 min
CSS specs	Dev Mode → Copy as CSS per element	Per screen

The PDF gives Claude the visual reference, the Batch Export handles assets, and Dev Mode copy-paste handles the precision specs. That combination is the fastest full export you can do.

In total there are about 50 screens in figma with reappearing components should the app be built screen by screen or components first in claude code?

Components first, without question. With 50 screens, building screen-by-screen would create a maintenance nightmare. Here's why and how:

Why Components First

With 50 screens and repeating components, screen-by-screen means:

- The same button gets rewritten 20+ times, slightly differently each time
- A spacing change on a card means editing 30 screens
- Claude loses consistency across long sessions (it *will* drift)
- Bugs get duplicated everywhere

Components first means you write a bottom nav once, and all 50 screens just *use* it.

The Right Build Order

Phase 1: Design System (1-2 sessions)

Start here before any screen or component:

- CSS custom properties (colors, fonts, spacing, shadows, border-radius)
- CSS reset + base typography
- Utility classes if needed

Tell Claude: *"Don't build any screens yet. Only build the design system foundation."*

Phase 2: Core Components (2-3 sessions)

Build every repeating element as a standalone, reusable piece:

- Buttons (primary, secondary, ghost, disabled, loading states)
- Inputs (text, password, search – with error/valid states)
- Cards (post card, user card, etc.)
- Navigation (top header, bottom tab bar)
- Avatars + badges
- Modals / bottom sheets
- List items
- Loading skeletons
- Toast / snackbar notifications

Test each component in isolation before moving on.

Phase 3: Screen Layouts (screen by screen)

Now screens become fast — they're just **assembling components**:

```
html

<!-- Each screen is mostly this: -->
<div class="screen">
  <Header title="Home" />
  <PostCard data="..." />
  <PostCard data="..." />
  <BottomNav active="home" />
</div>
```

Phase 4: Navigation & Routing

Wire all screens together with JS routing last, once all screens exist.

Phase 5: Logic & Data

Add all interactivity, API calls, and state management.

How to Manage 50 Screens with Claude Code

Group screens by flow, not one by one:

Session	Screens
Session 1	Design system only
Session 2	All components
Session 3	Onboarding flow (3-5 screens)
Session 4	Auth flow (login, register, forgot password)
Session 5	Home + Feed screens
Session 6	Profile screens
Session 7	Settings screens
Session 8	Navigation + routing
Session 9	Logic + polish

One Practical Tip

At the start of **every Claude Code session**, paste a short context block:

```
Project: [App Name] – HTML/CSS/JS mobile app
Components live in: /components/
Screens live in: /screens/
Design tokens: /style.css (CSS variables)
Current task: Building the auth flow screens using existing components
Do not rewrite or modify existing components unless I explicitly ask.
```

That last line is important — it prevents Claude from "improving" components mid-session and breaking consistency across screens.

can you do a checklist of all the important aspects for session 1 setting up the design system

Session 1 progress

13 / 40 complete

Colors

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- ☒ Every unique color from Figma noted as a hex value must
- ☒ Colors organized into named groups: primary, background, text, border, error, success, warning
- ☒ All CSS custom properties written in :root block must
- ☒ Opacity variants covered (e.g. overlay, disabled states)
- ☒ Dark/light variants noted if your app has a theme toggle

Typography

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- ☒ Font family name(s) confirmed and Google Fonts / self-hosted link ready must
- ☒ Every font size used across all 50 screens noted (e.g. 12, 14, 16, 18, 24, 32px) must
- ☒ Every font weight used noted (e.g. 400, 500, 600, 700) must
- ☒ Line heights noted per text style (tight for headings, relaxed for body)
- ☒ Letter spacing noted for any uppercase labels or special text
- ☒ All text styles mapped to CSS variables: text-xs, text-sm, text-base etc. must

Spacing & layout

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- ☐ Base spacing unit identified (usually 4px or 8px) must
- ☐ Full spacing scale defined: 4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64px as CSS variables must
- ☐ Screen max-width / frame width confirmed (e.g. 390px for iPhone) must
- ☐ Horizontal screen padding noted (the outer gutter used on all screens) must
- ☐ All border-radius values collected (e.g. 8px buttons, 16px cards, 50% avatars) must

Borders & shadows

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- ☒ Border widths noted (e.g. 1px, 1.5px, 2px)
- ☐ Border colors mapped to CSS variables
- ☒ All box-shadow values copied from Figma Dev Mode tip
- ☐ Divider / separator styles noted

Motion & transitions

0/3

- ☐ Default transition duration noted (e.g. 200ms for most hover states)
- ☐ Easing functions noted (e.g. ease, ease-in-out, cubic-bezier)
- ☐ Any screen transition style noted (slide, fade, etc.)

</> CSS file structure

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- ☐ All tokens written in a single :root block at top of style.css **must**
- ☐ CSS reset included (box-sizing, margin/padding reset, border-box) **must**
- ☐ Base body styles set: font, background, color, line-height **must**
- ☐ No component styles yet — tokens only in this session **must**
- ☐ File is commented with clear sections for easy navigation **tip**

📁 Project file structure

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- ☐ Folder structure agreed and created: /screens, /components, /assets **must**
- ☐ index.html created with correct viewport meta tag for mobile **must**
- ☐ style.css linked in index.html **must**
- ☐ app.js created and linked **must**
- ☐ Assets folders created: /assets/icons, /assets/images **must**
- ☐ All exported icons dropped into /assets/icons **must**
- ☐ All exported images dropped into /assets/images **must**

📋 Handoff to Claude Code

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- ☐ Context block written: project name, stack, viewport, file structure **must**
- ☐ All CSS variables pasted into the prompt **must**
- ☐ Figma screen PDF attached as visual reference **tip**
- ☐ Instruction added: do not build any components or screens yet — tokens only **must**
- ☐ Claude asked to confirm the design system before moving to Session 2 **tip**

Everything is interactive — check items off as you complete them and the progress bar tracks your session.

A few things worth highlighting: the "**must**" items are the non-negotiables Claude Code needs to produce consistent output. The "**tip**" items are things that save you pain later but won't block you from starting.

The most common mistake in Session 1 is accidentally letting Claude start building components. End your prompt with an explicit instruction like: *"Only output the style.css file with CSS variables and base styles. No components, no screens."* — otherwise it tends to run ahead.

